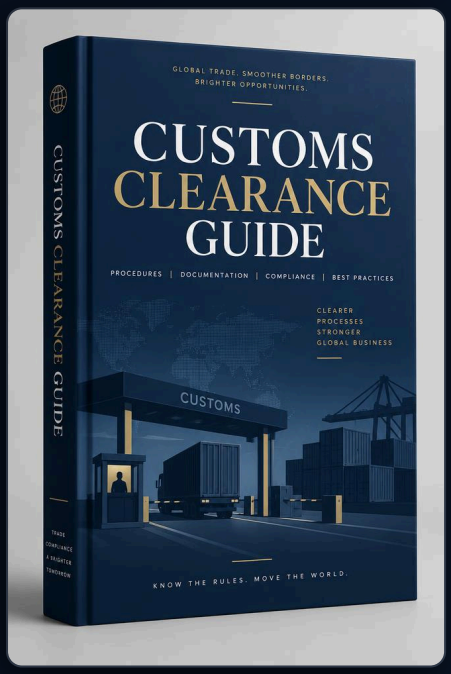
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OFFICIAL EXIM HANDBOOK

Customs Clearance Guide

Practical Flow of Import Clearance and How to Avoid Costly Port Delays

Mentor: Krishnakumar

30 Years Logistics, Customs & EXIM Documentation Experience

Comprehensive Edition

58 Pages • Digital PDF

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🎯 Mentor's Action Checklist & Operational Rules

- ✓ Prior Bill of Entry filed 48 hours before vessel arrival
- ✓ IGM details matched against Bill of Lading copy
- ✓ e-Sanchit digital document upload completed with correct document codes
- ✓ Customs duty paid electronically via ICEGATE within 24 hours of assessment
- ✓ Delivery Order (DO) obtained from shipping line prior to container gate-out

Confidential & Proprietary Training Material

CHAPTER 1

Vessel Arrival & IGM Inward Entry

The Customs clearance process officially begins when the shipping line or airline files the Import General Manifest (IGM) with Indian Customs before arrival.

Operational Steps: - Section 30 of Customs Act mandates electronic filing of IGM. - The IGM records container numbers, seal numbers, consignee IEC, package count, and gross weight. - If there is any spelling error in the consignee name or container number on the IGM, the importer must request an IGM Amendment, which requires approval from the Assistant Commissioner of Customs.

CHAPTER 2

Faceless Assessment (Turant Customs)

Under the Turant Customs initiative, Bills of Entry filed on ICEGATE are assigned randomly by an automated algorithm to a Faceless Assessment Group (FAG) officer anywhere in India.

The FAG Officer evaluates: 1. Classification (HSN) and correct rate of duty applied. 2. Valuation under Customs Valuation Rules 2007. 3. Country of Origin benefits claimed under preferential trade notifications. 4. Compliance with Non-Tariff barriers (BIS, FSSAI, EPR, Drug Controller approvals).

CHAPTER 3

Risk Management System (RMS) & Examination

Bills of Entry are categorized into three paths by the Risk Management System: - Green Channel: Appraised and cleared with zero officer intervention. Duty is paid and Out-of-Charge (OOC) generated immediately. - Assessment only: Verified by FAG officer without physical cargo examination. - Examination: Cargo undergoes physical inspection or scanning at the Container Freight Station (CFS) or port docks. First Check requires inspection before assessment; Second Check assesses duty first and inspects prior to physical gate release.

CHAPTER 4

Preventing Port Demurrage & Container Detention

Demurrage and detention can rapidly erode profit margins if not actively managed: - Demurrage: Billed by the Port or Container Freight Station (CFS) for cargo occupying ground space beyond free days (typically 3 to 5 free days). - Detention: Billed by the Shipping Line for retaining their container equipment outside the port terminal beyond free days (typically 7 to 14 free days). Golden Rule: File Prior Bill of Entry 48 hours before vessel berthing to ensure duty payment is completed the instant the container touches the dock.